Quinoa Mezze Style

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

Golden halloumi, green olives and za'atar give this quinoa salad plenty of character.

Serves 4–6 · Prep 15 min · Cook 20 min

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE SALAD

- 1 cup uncooked quinoa
- 1 medium green capsicum, deseeded and finely diced
- ½ cup pitted green olives, sliced
- 3 medium tomatoes, diced
- 250 g halloumi, cut into bite-sized pieces
- 1 tsp olive oil, for cooking the halloumi

FOR THE DRESSING

- 3 tbsp extra-virgin olive oil
- 3 tbsp fresh lemon juice, adjusted to taste
- Finely grated zest of 1 lemon
- 1 tbsp za'atar seasoning blend

METHOD

1. Cook the quinoa. Rinse the quinoa thoroughly in a fine sieve. Place in a saucepan and cook with water according to the packet instructions, until tender and the liquid has been absorbed.
2. Fluff with a fork, spread on a wide plate or tray and leave to cool.
3. Prepare the vegetables. Dice the capsicum and tomatoes and slice the olives. If the tomatoes release a lot of liquid, drain off the excess.
4. Make the dressing. Whisk together the olive oil, lemon juice, lemon zest and za'atar.
5. Cook the halloumi. Pat the halloumi dry. Heat the teaspoon of olive oil in a non-stick frying pan over medium-high heat. Add the halloumi and cook, turning, until golden on both sides.
6. Assemble. Toss the cooled quinoa with the capsicum, tomatoes, olives and dressing. Gently fold in the warm halloumi and serve.

Tip

Rinse the quinoa well. This helps remove any bitterness.